

Markscheme

Mathematics: analysis and approaches
Practice question bank

94. (a)

The product of any two consecutive integers, $n(n + 1)$, is always even, since one of the two integers must be even.

Using this result, find the smaller of two consecutive positive integers whose product is 812.

set up the equation: $n(n + 1) = 812$ (M1)

$$n^2 + n - 812 = 0 \quad \text{A1}$$

solve using the quadratic formula: $n = \frac{-1 \pm \sqrt{1 + 3248}}{2} = \frac{-1 \pm 57}{2}$ (M1) A1

reject the negative root; the smaller integer is $n = 28$ (check: $28 \times 29 = 812$) R1

[6 marks]